# DISTRESS TOLERANCE SESSION 6

Goals of Distress Tolerance
Pros and Cons
TIP Skills
Distracting (Wise Mind ACCEPTS)
Self-Soothing
Improving the Moment

# Goals of Distress Tolerance

## SURVIVE CRISIS SITUATIONS

**Without Making Them Worse**

## ACCEPT REALITY

**Replace Suffering and Being "Stuck"**
**with Ordinary Pain and the Possibility of Moving Forward**

## BECOME FREE

**Of Having to Satisfy**
**the Demands of Your Own**
**Desires, Urges, and Intense Emotions**

**OTHER: _____**

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# Overview:
# Crisis Survival Skills

**These are skills for tolerating painful events, urges, and emotions when you cannot make things better right away.**

**The STOP**

**Pros and Cons**

**TIP Your Body Chemistry**

**Distract with Wise Mind ACCEPTS**

**Self-Soothe with the Five Senses**

**Improve the Moment**

# When to Use Crisis Survival Skills

**YOU ARE IN A CRISIS when the situation is:**

- Highly stressful.
- Short-term (that is, it won't last a long time).
- Creates intense pressure to resolve the crisis *now*.

**USE CRISIS SURVIVAL SKILLS when:**

1. You have intense pain that cannot be helped quickly.
2. You want to act on your emotions, but it will only make things worse.
3. Emotion mind threatens to overwhelm you, and you need to stay skillful.
4. You are overwhelmed, yet demands must be met.
5. Arousal is extreme, but problems can't be solved immediately.

**DON'T USE CRISIS SURVIVAL SKILLS for:**

- Everyday problems.
- Solving all your life problems.
- Making your life worth living.

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# STOP Skill

| | |
|---|---|
| **S**top | Do not just react. Stop! Freeze! Do not move a muscle! Your emotions may try to make you act without thinking. Stay in control! |
| **T**ake a step back | Take a step back from the situation. Take a break. Let go. Take a deep breath. Do not let your feelings make you act impulsively. |
| **O**bserve | Notice what is going on inside and outside you. What is the situation? What are your thoughts and feelings? What are others saying or doing? |
| **P**roceed mindfully | Act with awareness. In deciding what to do, consider your thoughts and feelings, the situation, and other people's thoughts and feelings. Think about your goals. Ask Wise Mind: Which actions will make it better or worse? |

*Note.* Adapted from an unpublished worksheet by Francheska Perepletchikova and Seth Axelrod, with their permission.

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# Pros and Cons

Use pros and cons any time you have to decide between two courses of action.

- ❑ An urge is a crisis when it is very strong and when acting on the urge will make things *worse* in the long term.
- ❑ Make a list of the pros *and* cons of acting on your crisis urges. These might be to engage in dangerous, addictive, or harmful behaviors, or they might be to give in, give up, or avoid doing what is necessary to build a life you want to live.
- ❑ Make another list of the pros and cons of resisting crisis urges—that is, tolerating the distress and not giving in to the urges.
- ❑ Use the grid below to evaluate both sets of pros and cons (this type of grid is also used in Distress Tolerance Worksheet 3). Or you can use the type of grid seen in Distress Tolerance Worksheet 3a and in the pros-and-cons worksheets for other modules.

| | PROS | CONS |
|---|---|---|
| **Acting on crisis urges** | **Pros** of acting on impulsive urges, giving in, giving up, or avoiding what needs to be done.<br>_____<br>_____<br>_____<br>_____ | **Cons** of acting on impulsive urges, giving in, giving up, or avoiding what needs to be done.<br>_____<br>_____<br>_____<br>_____ |
| **Resisting crisis urges** | **Pros** of resisting impulsive urges, doing what needs to be done, and not giving up.<br>_____<br>_____<br>_____<br>_____ | **Cons** of resisting impulsive urges, doing what needs to be done, and not giving up.<br>_____<br>_____<br>_____<br>_____ |

**Before an overwhelming crisis urge hits:**

Write out your pros and cons; carry them with you.
Rehearse your pros and cons over and over.

**When an overwhelming crisis urge hits:**

Review your pros and cons. Get out your list and read it over again.

- Imagine the positive consequences of resisting the urge.
- Think of the negative consequences of giving in to crisis behaviors.
- Remember past consequences when you have acted on crisis urges.

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# TIP Skills: Changing Your Body Chemistry

**To reduce extreme emotion mind *fast*.**

Remember these as **TIP** skills:

**T**

**TIP THE TEMPERATURE of your face with COLD WATER***
**(to calm down fast)**

- Holding your breath, put your face in a bowl of cold water, or hold a cold pack (or zip-lock bag of cold water) on your eyes and cheeks.
- Hold for 30 seconds. Keep water above 50°F.

**I**

**INTENSE EXERCISE***
**(to calm down your body when it is revved up by emotion)**

- Engage in intense exercise, if only for a short while.
- Expend your body's stored up physical energy by running, walking fast, jumping, playing basketball, lifting weights, etc.

**P**

**PACED BREATHING**
**(pace your breathing by slowing it down)**

- Breathe deeply into your belly.
- Slow your pace of inhaling and exhaling way down (on average, five to six breaths per minute).
- Breathe *out* more slowly than you breathe *in* (for example, 5 seconds in and 7 seconds out).

**PAIRED MUSCLE RELAXATION**
**(to calm down by pairing muscle relaxation with breathing out)**

- While breathing into your belly, deeply tense your body muscles (*not* so much as to cause a cramp).
- Notice the tension in your body.
- While breathing out, say the word "Relax" in your mind.
- Let go of the tension.
- Notice the difference in your body.

***Caution:** Very cold water decreases your heart rate rapidly. Intense exercise will increase heart rate. Consult your health care provider before using these skills if you have a heart or medical condition, a lowered base heart rate due to medications, take a beta-blocker, are allergic to cold, or have an eating disorder.

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# Practicing the STOP Skill

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Describe two crisis situations that happened to you. Then describe your use of the STOP skill.

**CRISIS EVENT 1:** Rate level of distress (0–100) Before: _____ After: _____

**Prompting event** for my distress (who, what, when, where): What triggered the state of crisis?

Behavior you are trying to stop: _____

- ❑ **Stop**
- ❑ **Take a step back**
- ❑ **Observe**
- ❑ **Proceed mindfully**

At left, check the steps you used, and describe what you did here:

Describe the outcome of using skills:

Circle a number to indicate how effective the skill was in helping you tolerate the distress and cope with the situation (keeping you from doing something to make the situation worse). Use the following scale:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

**CRISIS EVENT 2:** Rate level of distress (0–100) Before: _____ After: _____

**Prompting event** for my distress (who, what, when, where): What triggered the state of crisis?

Behavior you are trying to stop: _____

- ❑ **Stop**
- ❑ **Take a step back**
- ❑ **Observe**
- ❑ **Proceed mindfully**

At left, check the steps you used, and describe what you did here:

Describe the outcome of using the skills:

Circle effectiveness of the skill:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

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## DISTRESS TOLERANCE WORKSHEET 3 (Distress Tolerance Handout 5)

# Pros and Cons of Acting on Crisis Urges

Due Date:_____ Name:_____Week Starting: _____

1. Describe the *problem behavior* you are trying to stop: _____
2. List pros and cons for acting on crisis urges (including urges to act and urges to quit), and create a separate list for resisting crisis behavior by tolerating distress and using skills.
3. Read the pros and cons when an urge toward the problem behavior occurs.

| Problem behavior | PROS | CONS |
|---|---|---|
| Acting on crisis urges | 1. | 1. |
| | 2. | 2. |
| | 3. | 3. |
| | 4. | 4. |
| | 5. | 5. |
| Resisting crisis urges | 1. | 1. |
| | 2. | 2. |
| | 3. | 3. |
| | 4. | 4. |
| | 5. | 5. |

Identify which pros and cons are short-term (just for today) or long-term (beyond today). Then ask your Wise Mind: Would you rather have a good day or a good life? Make a mindful choice about your behavior.

If this worksheet helps you choose skillful behavior over crisis behavior, be sure to keep it where you can find it and review it again when you are in crisis.

Adapted from an unpublished worksheet by Seth Axelrod, with his permission.

## DISTRESS TOLERANCE WORKSHEET 4

# Changing Body Chemistry with TIP Skills

Due Date:_____ Name:_____Week Starting: _____

Describe the situation you were in when you chose to practice each skill. Rate both your emotional arousal and distress tolerance before and after using the TIP skill. Describe what you actually did.

T

**CHANGING MY FACIAL TEMPERATURE**

Used cold water to change emotions

Situation: _____

Arousal (0–100) Before: _____ After: _____

Distress tolerance (0 = I can't stand it; 100 = I can survive) Before: ____ After: ____

What I did (describe): _____

_____

I

**INTENSE EXERCISE**

Situation: _____

Arousal (0–100) Before:_____After: _____

Distress tolerance (0 = I can't stand it; 100 = I can survive) Before: _____After: ____

What I did (describe): _____

_____

P

**PACED BREATHING**

Situation: _____

Arousal (0–100) Before:_____After: _____

Distress tolerance (0 = I can't stand it; 100 = I can survive) Before: _____After: ____

What I did (describe): _____

_____

**PAIRED MUSCLE RELAXATION**

Situation: _____

Arousal (0–100) Before:_____After: _____

Distress tolerance (0 = I can't stand it; 100 = I can survive) Before: _____After: ____

What I did (describe): _____

_____

# Distracting with Wise Mind ACCEPTS

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Describe two crisis situations that happened to you. Then describe your use of the ACCEPTS skills.

**CRISIS EVENT 1:** Rate level of distress (0–100) Before: _____ After: _____

**Prompting event** for my distress (who, what, when, where): What triggered the state of crisis?

- ❑ **Activities**
- ❑ **Contributions**
- ❑ **Comparisons**
- ❑ **Emotions**
- ❑ **Pushing away**
- ❑ **Thoughts**
- ❑ **Sensations**

At left, check the skills you used, and describe here:

Describe the outcome of using skills:

Circle a number to indicate how effective the skills were in helping you tolerate the distress and cope with the situation (keeping you from doing something to make the situation worse). Use the following scale:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

**CRISIS EVENT 2:** Rate level of distress (0–100) Before: _____ After: _____

**Prompting event** for my distress (who, what, when, where): What triggered the state of crisis?

- ❑ **Activities**
- ❑ **Contributions**
- ❑ **Comparisons**
- ❑ **Emotions**
- ❑ **Pushing away**
- ❑ **Thoughts**
- ❑ **Sensations**

At left, check the skills you used, and describe here:

Describe the outcome of using skills:

Circle effectiveness of skills:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

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## DISTRESS TOLERANCE WORKSHEET 5B (Distress Tolerance Handout 7)

# Distracting with Wise Mind ACCEPTS

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

For each ACCEPTS skill, write down what you did during the week, and write down a number to indicate how effective the skill was in helping you tolerate the distress and cope with the situation (keeping you from doing something to make the situation worse). Use the following scale:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

**Day:** **ACTIVITIES**

_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **CONTRIBUTIONS**

_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **COMPARISONS**

_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **EMOTIONS**

_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **PUSHING AWAY**

_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **THOUGHTS**

_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **SENSATIONS**

_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____
_____ /_____ Effectiveness: _____

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# Distracting

A way to remember these skills is the phrase **"Wise Mind ACCEPTS."**

## With **A**ctivities:

- ❑ Focus attention on a task you need to get done.
- ❑ Rent movies; watch TV.
- ❑ Clean a room in your house.
- ❑ Find an event to go to.
- ❑ Play computer games.
- ❑ Go walking. Exercise.
- ❑ Surf the Internet. Write e-mails.
- ❑ Play sports.
- ❑ Go out for a meal or eat a favorite food.
- ❑ Call or go out with a friend.
- ❑ Listen to your iPod; download music.
- ❑ Build something.
- ❑ Spend time with your children.
- ❑ Play cards.
- ❑ Read magazines, books, comics.
- ❑ Do crossword puzzles or Sudoku.
- ❑ Other: _____

## With **C**ontributing:

- ❑ Find volunteer work to do.
- ❑ Help a friend or family member.
- ❑ Surprise someone with something nice (a card, a favor, a hug).
- ❑ Give away things you don't need.
- ❑ Call or send an instant message encouraging someone or just saying hi.
- ❑ Make something nice for someone else.
- ❑ Do something thoughtful.
- ❑ Other: _____

## With **C**omparisons:

- ❑ Compare how you are feeling now to a time when you felt different.
- ❑ Think about people coping the same as you or less well than you.
- ❑ Compare yourself to those less fortunate.
- ❑ Watch reality shows about others' troubles; read about disasters, others' suffering.
- ❑ Other: _____

## With different **E**motions:

- ❑ Read emotional books or stories, old letters.
- ❑ Watch emotional TV shows; go to emotional movies.
- ❑ Listen to emotional music.

*(Be sure the event creates different emotions.)*

*Ideas*: Scary movies, joke books, comedies, funny records, religious music, soothing music or music that fires you up, going to a store and reading funny greeting cards.

- ❑ Other: _____

## With **P**ushing away:

- ❑ Push the situation away by leaving it for a while.
- ❑ Leave the situation mentally.
- ❑ Build an imaginary wall between yourself and the situation.
- ❑ Block thoughts and images from your mind.
- ❑ Notice ruminating: Yell "No!"
- ❑ Refuse to think about the painful situations.
- ❑ Put the pain on a shelf. Box it up and put it away for a while.
- ❑ Deny the problem for the moment.
- ❑ Other: _____

## With other **T**houghts:

- ❑ Count to 10; count colors in a painting or poster or out the window; count anything.
- ❑ Repeat words to a song in your mind.
- ❑ Work puzzles.
- ❑ Watch TV or read.
- ❑ Other: _____

## With other **S**ensations:

- ❑ Squeeze a rubber ball very hard.
- ❑ Listen to very loud music.
- ❑ Hold ice in your hand or mouth.
- ❑ Go out in the rain or snow.
- ❑ Take a hot or cold shower.
- ❑ Other: _____

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# Self-Soothing

A way to remember these skills is to think of soothing each of your **FIVE SENSES.**

With **Vision:**

- ❑ Look at the stars at night.
- ❑ Look at pictures you like in a book.
- ❑ Buy one beautiful flower.
- ❑ Make one space in a room pleasing to look at.
- ❑ Light a candle and watch the flame.
- ❑ Set a pretty place at the table using your best things.
- ❑ Go people-watching or window-shopping.
- ❑ Go to a museum or poster shop with beautiful art.
- ❑ Sit in the lobby of a beautiful old hotel.
- ❑ Look at nature around you.
- ❑ Walk in a pretty part of town.
- ❑ Watch a sunrise or a sunset.
- ❑ Go to a dance performance, or watch it on TV.
- ❑ Be mindful of each sight that passes in front of you.
- ❑ Take a walk in a park or a scenic hike.
- ❑ Browse through stores looking at things.
- ❑ Other: _____

With **Hearing:**

- ❑ Listen to soothing or invigorating music.
- ❑ Pay attention to sounds of nature (waves, birds, rainfall, leaves rustling).
- ❑ Pay attention to the sounds of the city (traffic, horns, city music).
- ❑ Sing to your favorite songs.
- ❑ Hum a soothing tune.
- ❑ Learn to play an instrument.
- ❑ Burn a CD or make an iPod mix with music that will get you through tough times. Turn it on.
- ❑ Be mindful of any sounds that come your way, letting them go in one ear and out the other.
- ❑ Turn on the radio.
- ❑ Other: _____

With **Smell:**

- ❑ Use your favorite soap, shampoo, aftershave, cologne, or lotions, or try them on in the store.
- ❑ Burn incense or light a scented candle.
- ❑ Open a package of coffee and inhale the aroma.
- ❑ Put lemon oil on your furniture.
- ❑ Put potpourri or eucalyptus oil in a bowl in your room.
- ❑ Sit in a new car and breathe the aroma.
- ❑ Boil cinnamon. Make cookies, bread, or popcorn.
- ❑ Smell the roses.
- ❑ Walk in a wooded area and mindfully breathe in the fresh smells of nature.
- ❑ Open the window and smell the air.
- ❑ Other: _____

With **Taste:**

- ❑ Eat some of your favorite foods.
- ❑ Drink your favorite soothing drink, such as herbal tea, hot chocolate, a latté, or a smoothie.
- ❑ Treat yourself to a dessert.
- ❑ Eat macaroni and cheese or another favorite childhood food.
- ❑ Sample flavors in an ice cream store.
- ❑ Suck on a piece of peppermint candy.
- ❑ Chew your favorite gum.
- ❑ Get a little bit of a special food you don't usually spend the money on, such as fresh-squeezed orange juice or your favorite candy.
- ❑ Really taste the food you eat. Eat one thing mindfully.
- ❑ Other: _____

With **Touch:**

- ❑ Take a long hot bath or shower.
- ❑ Pet your dog or cat.
- ❑ Have a massage. Soak your feet.
- ❑ Put creamy lotion on your whole body.
- ❑ Put a cold compress on your forehead.
- ❑ Sink into a comfortable chair in your home.
- ❑ Put on a blouse or shirt that has a pleasant feel.
- ❑ Take a drive with the car windows rolled down.
- ❑ Run your hand along smooth wood or leather.
- ❑ Hug someone.
- ❑ Put clean sheets on the bed.
- ❑ Wrap up in a blanket.
- ❑ Notice touch that is soothing.
- ❑ Other: _____

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# Improving the Moment

A way to remember these skills is the word **IMPROVE.**

With **Imagery:**

- ❑ Imagine very relaxing scenes.
- ❑ Imagine a secret room within yourself. Furnish it the way you like. Close and lock the door on anything that can hurt you.
- ❑ Imagine everything going well.
- ❑ Make up a calming fantasy world.
- ❑ Imagine hurtful emotions draining out of you like water out of a pipe.
- ❑ Remember a happy time and imagine yourself in it again; play out the time in your mind again.
- ❑ Other: _____

With **Meaning:**

- ❑ Find purpose or meaning in a painful situation.
- ❑ Focus on whatever positive aspects of a painful situation you can find.
- ❑ Repeat these positive aspects in your mind.
- ❑ Remember, listen to, or read about spiritual values.
- ❑ Other: _____

With **Prayer:**

- ❑ Open your heart to a supreme being, God, or your own Wise Mind.
- ❑ Ask for strength to bear the pain.
- ❑ Turn things over to God or a higher being.
- ❑ Other: _____

With **Relaxing** actions:

- ❑ Take a hot bath or sit in a hot tub.
- ❑ Drink hot milk.
- ❑ Massage your neck and scalp.
- ❑ Practice yoga or other stretching.
- ❑ Breathe deeply.
- ❑ Change your facial expression.
- ❑ Other: _____

With **One thing in the moment:**

- ❑ Focus your entire attention on just what you are doing.
- ❑ Keep yourself in the moment.
- ❑ Put your mind in the present.
- ❑ Focus your entire attention on the physical
- ❑ Listen to a sensory awareness recording (or use Distress Tolerance Handout 9a)
- ❑ Other: _____

With a brief **Vacation:**

- ❑ Give yourself a brief vacation.
- ❑ Get in bed; pull the covers up over your head.
- ❑ Go to the beach or the woods for the day.
- ❑ Get a magazine and read it with chocolates.
- ❑ Turn off your phone for a day.
- ❑ Take a blanket to the park and sit on it for a whole afternoon.
- ❑ Take a 1-hour breather from hard work.
- ❑ Take a brief vacation from responsibility.
- ❑ Other: _____

With self-**Encouragement and rethinking the situation:**

- ❑ Cheerlead yourself: "You got this!"
- ❑ "I will make it out of this."
- ❑ "I'm doing the best I can."
- ❑ Repeat over and over: "I can stand it."
- ❑ "This too shall pass."
- ❑ "I will be OK."
- ❑ "It won't last forever."
- ❑ Other: _____

List (and then practice) rethoughts that are particularly important in your crisis situations (e.g., "The fact that he did not pick me up doesn't mean he doesn't love me"):

❑ _____ ❑ _____

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## DISTRESS TOLERANCE WORKSHEET 6 (Distress Tolerance Handout 8)

# Self-Soothing

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Describe two crisis situations that happened to you. Then describe your use of the self-soothing skills.

**CRISIS EVENT 1:** Rate level of distress (0–100) Before: _____ After: _____

**Prompting event** for my distress (who, what, when, where): What triggered the state of crisis?

- ❑ **Vision**
- ❑ **Hearing**
- ❑ **Smell**
- ❑ **Taste**
- ❑ **Touch**

At left, check the skills you used, and describe here:

Describe the outcome of using skills:

Circle a number to indicate how effective the skills were in helping you tolerate the distress and cope with the situation (keeping you from doing something to make the situation worse). Use the following scale:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

**CRISIS EVENT 2:** Rate level of distress (0–100) Before: _____ After: _____

**Prompting event** for my distress (who, what, when, where): What triggered the state of crisis?

- ❑ **Vision**
- ❑ **Hearing**
- ❑ **Smell**
- ❑ **Taste**
- ❑ **Touch**

At left, check the skills you used, and describe here:

Describe the outcome of using skills:

Circle effectiveness of skills:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

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# Self-Soothing

Due Date:_____ Name:_____Week Starting: _____

For each self-soothing skill, write down what you did during the week, and write down a number to indicate how effective the skill was in helping you tolerate the distress and cope with the situation (keeping you from doing something to make the situation worse). Use the following scale:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for onemore minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

**Day:** **VISION**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **HEARING**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **SMELL**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **TASTE**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **TOUCH**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

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## DISTRESS TOLERANCE WORKSHEET 7 (Distress Tolerance Handout 9)

# IMPROVE the Moment

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Describe two crisis situations that happened to you. Then describe your use of the IMPROVE skills.

**CRISIS EVENT 1:** Rate level of distress (0–100) Before: _____ After: _____

**Prompting event** for my distress (who, what, when, where): What triggered the state of crisis?

- ❑ **Imagery**
- ❑ **Meaning**
- ❑ **Prayer**
- ❑ **Relaxation**
- ❑ **One thing**
- ❑ **Vacation**
- ❑ **Encouragement**

At left, check the skills you used, and describe here:

Describe the outcome of using skills:

Circle a number to indicate how effective the skills were in helping you tolerate the distress and cope with the situation (keeping you from doing something to make the situation worse). Use the following scale:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

**CRISIS EVENT 2:** Rate level of distress (0–100) Before: _____ After: _____

**Prompting event** for my distress (who, what, when, where): What triggered the state of crisis?

- ❑ **Imagery**
- ❑ **Meaning**
- ❑ **Prayer**
- ❑ **Relaxation**
- ❑ **One thing**
- ❑ **Vacation**
- ❑ **Encouragement**

At left, check the skills you used, and describe here:

Describe the outcome of using skills:

Circle effectiveness of skills:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

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# IMPROVE the Moment

Due Date:_____ Name:_____Week Starting: _____

For each IMPROVE skill, write down what you did during the week, and write down a number to indicate how effective the skill was in helping you tolerate the distress and cope with the situation (keeping you from doing something to make the situation worse). Use the following scale:

| *I still couldn't stand the situation, even for onemore minute.* | | *I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.* | | *I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** | **5** |

**Day:** **IMAGERY**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **MEANING**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **PRAYER**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **RELAXATION**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **ONE THING IN THE MOMENT**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **VACATION**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

**Day:** **ENCOURAGEMENT**

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

_____ /_____Effectiveness: _____

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